⌨️ Robot Keyboard Control

1. Course Introduction

This course will introduce how to control the **chassis movement** of the **A1 Pro** robot and the individual joint servos of the **6-DOF robotic arm** via keyboard. Through this lesson, you will gain an in-depth understanding of the ROS 2 keyboard control node's working mechanism, topic communication flow, Ackerman chassis kinematics constraints, and the coordinated control logic of the underlying hardware drivers.

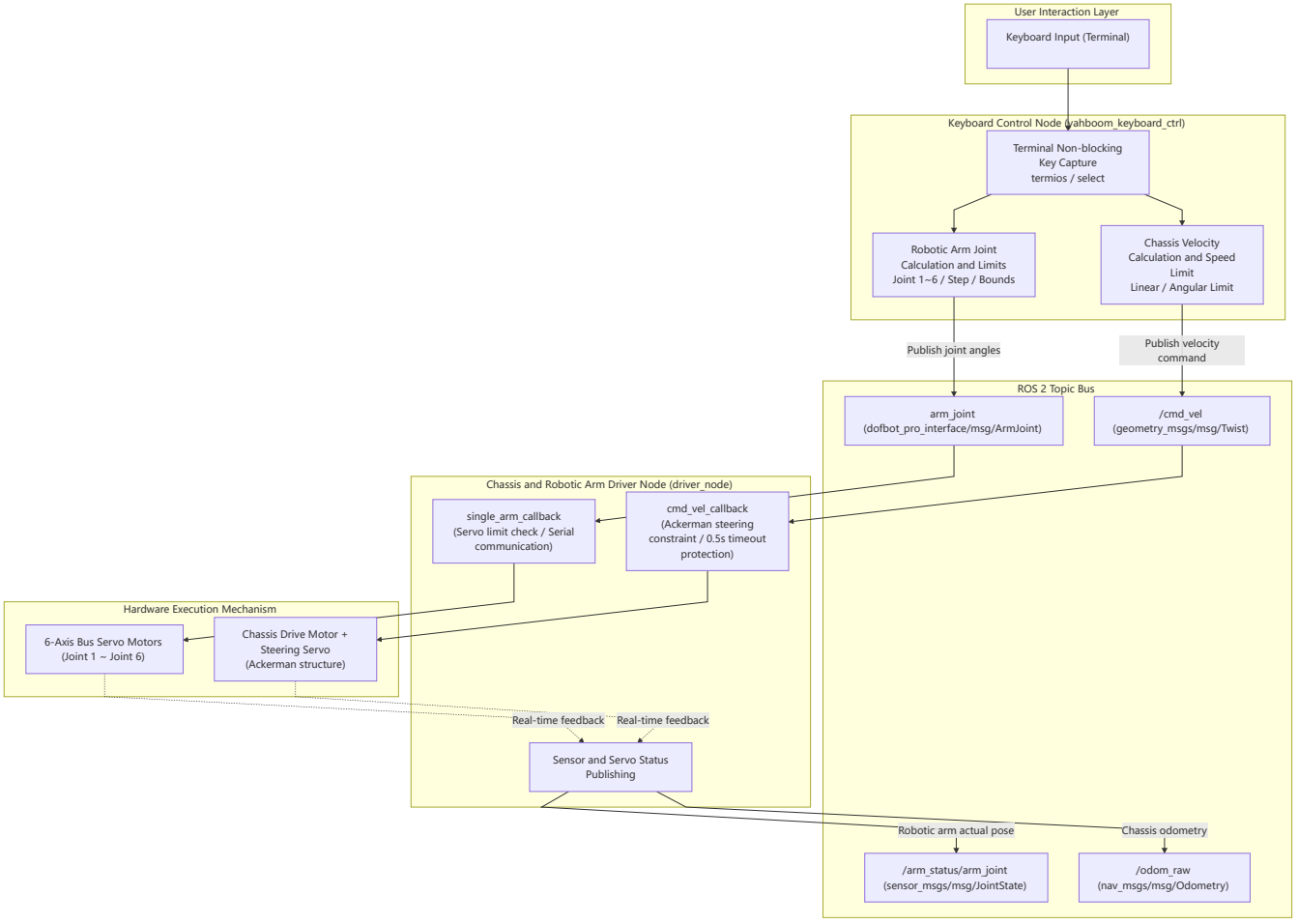
🎯 Course Objectives

1. **Master the startup and parameter configuration of the keyboard control node**: Learn how to launch via command line and modify control step size and speed limit parameters as needed.
2. **Proficiently master key mappings and operations**: Master omnidirectional/directional movement of the chassis, dynamic speed adjustment, robotic arm joint 1~6 selection and angle fine-tuning, and one-key reset operations.
3. **Understand system communication topology and message definitions**: Master the data flow and roles of `/cmd_vel` (`geometry_msgs/msg/Twist`) and `arm_joint` (`dofbot_pro_interface/msg/ArmJoint`).
4. **In-depth mastery of source code implementation and safety mechanisms**: Understand terminal non-blocking key capture, Ackerman non-omnidirectional chassis constraints, command timeout protection, and servo software/hardware limit protection mechanisms.

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2. System Architecture and Communication Topology

The keyboard control node `yahboom_keyboard.py` serves as the upper-layer control interaction node, collecting user keyboard input and simultaneously publishing chassis velocity commands and robotic arm servo commands. The underlying driver node `Ackman_driver_A1P.py` (node name `driver_node`) receives commands and communicates with the STM32/Rosmaster expansion board via serial port, driving motors and bus servos to execute actions while providing real-time robot status feedback.



3. Preparation Work

3.1 Start Chassis Hardware Driver

Open a terminal and run the following launch file to start the chassis and robotic arm driver nodes for the A1 Pro robot:

```
ros2 launch yahboomcar_bringup yahboomcar_bringup_A1_launch.py
```

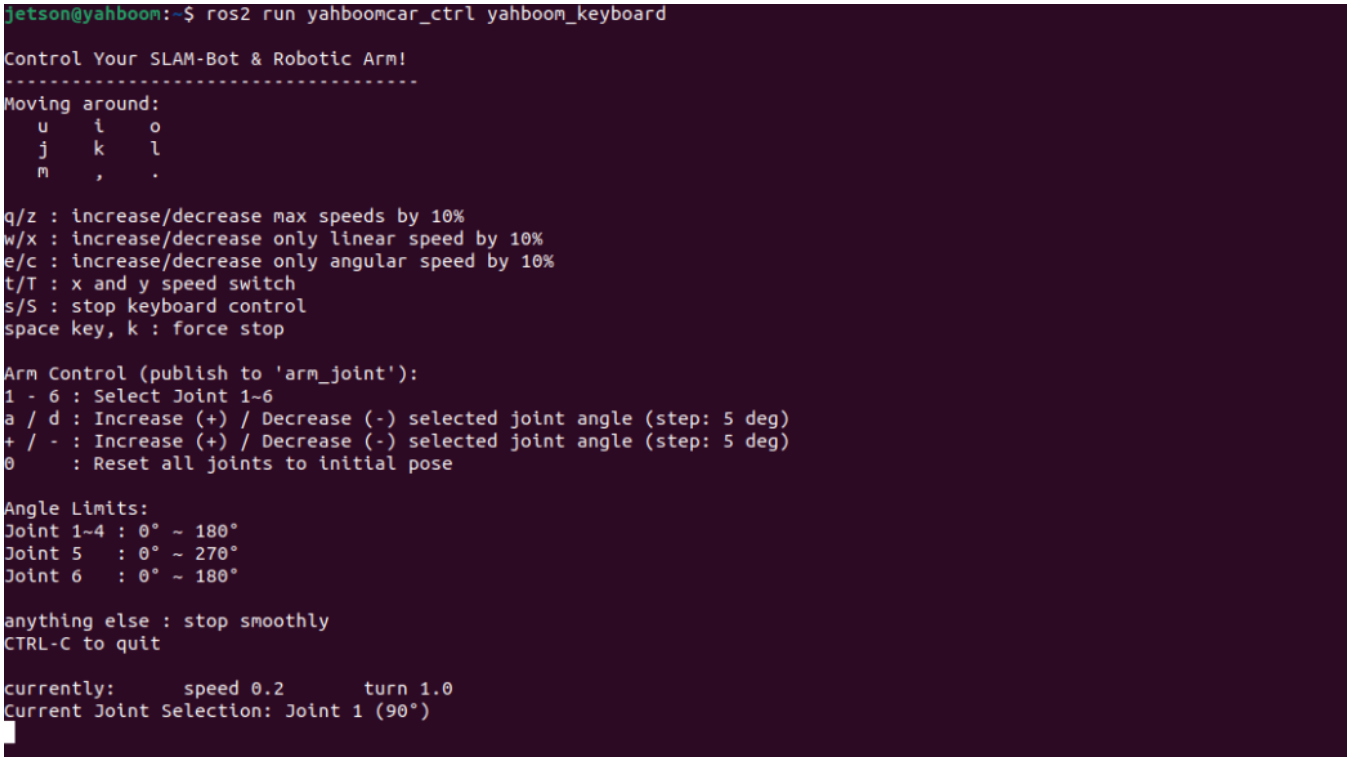
```
jetson@yahboom:~$ ros2 launch yahboomcar_bringup yahboomcar_bringup_A1_launch.py
[INFO] [launch]: All log files can be found below /home/jetson/.ros/log/2026-08-28-16-44-35-633832-yahboom-821017
[INFO] [launch]: Default logging verbosity is set to INFO
--------------------robot_type = A1--------------------
[INFO] [joint_state_publisher-1]: process started with pid [821067]
[INFO] [robot_state_publisher-2]: process started with pid [821069]
[INFO] [Ackman_driver_A1P-3]: process started with pid [821071]
[INFO] [base_node_A1-4]: process started with pid [821073]
[INFO] [imu_attitude_converter-5]: process started with pid [821075]
[INFO] [ekf_node-6]: process started with pid [821079]
[base_node_A1-4] [INFO] [1787906675.885494189] [base_node]: A1 odometry: linear_scale_x=1.000000 angular_scale_z=1.000000 wheelbase_
compat=0.250 max_dt=0.500
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.907244026] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment Gripping
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.909930386] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm1
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.912370306] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm2
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.914098747] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm3
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.915760850] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm4
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.917022524] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm5
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.918052894] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment arm_base_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.918900186] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment base_footprint
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919686419] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment base_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919718901] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment camera_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919735349] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment imu_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919749526] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment laser_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919760406] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment lbw_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919770838] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment lfr_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919779639] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment lfw_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919788983] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment llink1
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919798679] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment llink2
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919807671] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment llink3
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919816120] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rbw_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919827928] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rfr_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919837048] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rfw_Link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919846073] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rlink1
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919854841] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rlink2
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1787906675.919863289] [robot_state_publisher]: got segment rlink3
[joint_state_publisher-1] [INFO] [1787906676.785296815] [joint_state_publisher]: Waiting for robot_description to be published on th
e robot_description topic...
[imu_attitude_converter-5] [INFO] [1787906676.956745278] [imu_display_tf]: IMU attitude converter: /imu/data_raw -> /imu/data, publi
sh_tf=False
[Ackman_driver_A1P-3] [INFO] [1787906677.718445557] [driver_node]: A1 driver initialized: imu_link=imu_link, pub_hz=20.0, arm_status
_hz=5.0, cmd_vel_timeout=0.50s
```

> **Note**
>
> After successful driver startup, the robotic arm will automatically execute a power-on reset motion (moving to initial pose `[90, 120, 0, 0, 90, 0]`), and the terminal will output `A1 driver initialized` related information.

3.2 Start Keyboard Control Node

Run the keyboard control node in a **new terminal**:

```
ros2 run yahboomcar_ctrl yahboom_keyboard
```



> **Important**
>
> 1. **Window Focus**: The keyboard control node captures key presses through terminal standard input. Ensure the **terminal window running keyboard control is active/selected**.
> 2. **Input Method State**: Must switch the input method to **English half-width mode**. Chinese input method will intercept key presses and cause no response.
> 3. **Safe Operation**: Ensure there is sufficient open space around the vehicle before movement to avoid collisions.

3.3 (Advanced) Custom Parameter Startup

The keyboard control node supports dynamic configuration of speed limits, servo step size, servo movement time, etc. via ROS 2 parameters. For example, to adjust the robotic arm step angle to 10° with single-step execution time of 300ms:

```
ros2 run yahboomcar_ctrl yahboom_keyboard --ros-args -p arm_joint_step:=10 -p
arm_joint_time:=300
```

---

4. Key Operation Guide

4.1 Chassis Motion Control

Key	Function Description	Kinematics Command (`geometry_msgs/msg/Twist`)
`i` / `I`	**Forward**	`linear.x = +speed`, `angular.z = 0`
`,`	**Backward**	`linear.x = -speed`, `angular.z = 0`

Key	Function Description	Kinematics Command (`geometry_msgs/msg/Twist`)
`u` / `U`	**Move left-forward** (forward + left turn)	`linear.x = +speed`, `angular.z = +turn`
`o` / `O`	**Move right-forward** (forward + right turn)	`linear.x = +speed`, `angular.z = -turn`
`m` / `M`	**Move left-backward** (backward + left turn)	`linear.x = -speed`, `angular.z = -turn`
`.`	**Move right-backward** (backward + right turn)	`linear.x = -speed`, `angular.z = +turn`
`k` / `Space`	**Emergency forced stop**	Immediately clear velocity and publish all-zero command
`Other unbound keys`	**Smooth deceleration stop**	Automatically brake after 5 consecutive cycles without valid movement input

> ⚠ **Warning**
>
> **Ackerman Chassis Steering Special Note**:
>
> The A1 Pro chassis uses front-wheel Ackermann steering + rear-wheel dual motor drive structure, and **physically does not support in-place rotation (zero-radius turn)**.
> In the underlying driver `Ackman_driver_A1P.py`, when linear velocity $v_x = 0$, angular velocity ω_z is forcibly set to zero to protect the front-wheel steering servo.
> Therefore, pressing `j` or `l` alone will not cause the vehicle to move. **Movement keys (such as `u`, `o`, `m`, `.`) must be used in combination to generate steering motion**.

4.2 Speed Adjustment and Speed Limit Protection

The node default initial linear velocity is **0.2 m/s**, and initial angular velocity is **1.0 rad/s**.

Key	Function Description	Adjustment Ratio
`q` / `Q`	**Increase** both linear and angular velocity by 10%	$\times 1.1$
`z` / `Z`	**Decrease** both linear and angular velocity by 10%	$\times 0.9$
`w` / `W`	**Increase linear velocity only** by 10%	Linear velocity $\times 1.1$
`x` / `X`	**Decrease linear velocity only** by 10%	Linear velocity $\times 0.9$
`e` / `E`	**Increase angular velocity only** by 10%	Angular velocity $\times 1.1$
`c` / `C`	**Decrease angular velocity only** by 10%	Angular velocity $\times 0.9$

> 💡 **Tip**
>
> The node has built-in maximum speed protection mechanisms:

> - Maximum linear velocity limit: Limited by `linear_speed_limit` parameter (default 1.0 m/s)
> - Maximum angular velocity limit: Limited by `angular_speed_limit` parameter (default 5.0 rad/s, the underlying driver further limits to within 3.0 rad/s)
>
> When speed reaches the set limit, the terminal will print `Linear speed limit reached!` or `Angular speed limit reached!` prompts.

4.3 Robotic Arm 6-DOF Control

The A1 Pro is equipped with 6-DOF serial bus servos. The keyboard control node supports single-joint selection adjustment and one-key pose reset.

Key	Function Description	Corresponding Action and Output
`1` ~ `6`	**Select currently controlled joint** (Joint 1 ~ 6)	Terminal displays selected joint number, current angle, and allowed range of motion
`a` / `A` / `+` / `=`	**Increase** current selected joint angle (default +5°)	Publish `ArmJoint` message, auto-clamp at upper limit
`d` / `D` / `-` / `_`	**Decrease** current selected joint angle (default -5°)	Publish `ArmJoint` message, auto-clamp at lower limit
`0`	**One-key reset** all 6 joints to initial pose	Restore to `[90, 120, 0, 0, 90, 0]`, execution time 1500ms

Servo Parameters and Angle Limits Reference Table

Servo Number	Joint Name (URDF Joint)	Allowed Angle Range (`arm_bounds`)	Default Initial Angle (`init_pose`)	Mechanism Motion Function Description
Servo 1	`arm1_Joint`	**0° ~ 180°**	90°	Robotic arm base left-right horizontal rotation (90° is straight ahead)
Servo 2	`arm2_Joint`	**-60°~ 180°**	120°	Upper arm front-back pitch (controls robotic arm extension range)
Servo 3	`arm3_Joint`	**-20° ~ 180°**	0°	Forearm up-down pitch (controls end effector working height)
Servo 4	`arm4_Joint`	**-20° ~ 180°**	0°	Wrist up-down pitch (adjusts end effector gripper pose pitch angle)

Servo Number	Joint Name (URDF Joint)	Allowed Angle Range (`arm_bounds`)	Default Initial Angle (`init_pose`)	Mechanism Motion Function Description
Servo 5	`arm5_Joint`	**0° ~ 270°**	90°	Wrist rotation servo (adjusts gripper horizontal/vertical rotation angle)
Servo 6	`rlink1_Joint`	**0° ~ 180°**	0°	End effector gripper open-close (0° is fully open, closing angle adapts to held object size)

4.4 Auxiliary and Status Toggle Keys

Key	Function Description	Notes
`s` / `S`	**Pause / Resume keyboard control**	Toggle stop flag. When paused, continuously publish all-zero velocity, blocking movement commands
`Ctrl + C`	**Safe exit**	Automatically restore terminal original settings and send stop command to chassis

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5. Source Code Analysis and Core Mechanism Implementation

Source code file location:

```
~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/src/yahboomcar_ctrl/yahboomcar_ctrl/yahboom_keyboard.py
```

5.1 ROS 2 Node Initialization and Parameter Declaration

In the `Yahboom_Keybord` class constructor, the node completes publisher creation, parameter declaration, and terminal environment preservation:

```python
class Yahboom_Keybord(Node):
    def __init__(self, name):
        super().__init__(name)
        # Create chassis velocity publisher and robotic arm servo publisher
        self.pub = self.create_publisher(Twist, 'cmd_vel', 1)
        self.pub_arm = self.create_publisher(ArmJoint, 'arm_joint', 10)

        # Declare configurable ROS 2 parameters
        self.declare_parameter("linear_speed_limit", 1.0)
        self.declare_parameter("angular_speed_limit", 5.0)
        self.declare_parameter("arm_joint_step", 5)
        self.declare_parameter("arm_joint_time", 200)
```

```
        self.declare_parameter("init_pose", [90, 120, 0, 0, 90, 0])
        self.declare_parameter(
            "arm_bounds",
            [0.0, 180.0, 0.0, 180.0, 0.0, 180.0, 0.0, 180.0, 0.0, 270.0, 0.0, 180.0]
        )

        # Load parameters and initial pose
        self.linenar_speed_limit = float(self.get_parameter("linear_speed_limit").value)
        self.angular_speed_limit = float(self.get_parameter("angular_speed_limit").value)
        self.arm_joint_step = int(self.get_parameter("arm_joint_step").value)
        self.arm_joint_time = int(self.get_parameter("arm_joint_time").value)

        # Save terminal attributes for restoration on exit
        self.settings = termios.tcgetattr(sys.stdin)
```

5.2 Terminal Non-blocking Key Capture

Standard input is set to Raw mode via the Linux standard `termios` module, combined with `select.select` with 0.1 second timeout to achieve single-character immediate reading without pressing Enter:

```
def getKey(self):
    tty.setraw(sys.stdin.fileno())
    rlist, _, _ = select.select([sys.stdin], [], [], 0.1)
    if rlist:
        key = sys.stdin.read(1)
    else:
        key = ''
    termios.tcsetattr(sys.stdin, termios.TCSADRAIN, self.settings)
    return key
```

5.3 Robotic Arm Servo Adjustment and One-key Reset

When receiving angle adjustment keys, the node calculates target angle, performs range limiting, and packs/publishes `ArmJoint` messages:

```
def adjust_joint(self, joint_id, delta):
    if joint_id < 1 or joint_id > 6:
        return
    idx = joint_id - 1
    lower, upper = self.arm_bounds[idx]
    # Software safety limit clipping
    new_angle = max(lower, min(upper, self.arm_joints[idx] + delta))
    self.arm_joints[idx] = new_angle
    # Publish single servo control command, single step time 200ms
    self.pub_arm_joint(joint_id, new_angle, self.arm_joint_time)
    print(f"\r[Arm] Joint {joint_id}: {new_angle}° (Limits: {lower}~{upper}°)")

def reset_arm(self):
    init_pose_param = list(self.get_parameter("init_pose").value)
    self.arm_joints = [int(angle) for angle in init_pose_param]
    # Iterate and publish all 6 joints, execution time set to 1500ms for smooth return
```

```
    for joint_id, angle in enumerate(self.arm_joints, start=1):
        self.pub_arm_joint(joint_id, angle, 1500)
    print(f"\r[Arm] Reset all joints to: {self.arm_joints}")
```

5.4 Underlying Driver Response and Safety Protection Mechanisms

The underlying driver `Ackman_driver_A1P.py` provides multiple safety and kinematics guarantees:

1. **Ackerman Non-omnidirectional Kinematics Filtering**:

   ```
   # When linear velocity is 0, force angular velocity to 0 to prevent in-place steering from damaging the steering mechanism
   if abs(vx) < 1e-4:
       vx = 0.0
       angular = 0.0
   ```

2. **Communication Timeout Protection (Watchdog)**:
   The driver maintains `cmd_vel_timeout` (default 0.5s). If the keyboard node crashes or exits abnormally, and no new velocity command is received for more than 0.5 seconds, the driver thread will automatically trigger shutdown protection.

3. **Robotic Arm Status Feedback Loop**:
   After executing servo motions, the driver publishes `sensor_msgs/msg/JointState` status on the `/arm_status/arm_joint` topic at 5Hz frequency, enabling the robot 3D model in RViz2 to maintain real-time pose synchronization with the physical robotic arm.

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6. Operation Verification and Debugging Tips

6.1 Verify Chassis Velocity Command Publishing

Execute the following command in another terminal to observe the data flow of the `/cmd_vel` topic when pressing keys:

```
ros2 topic echo /cmd_vel
```

When pressing `i` for forward movement, you will see output similar to:

```
linear:
  x: 0.20000000298023224
  y: 0.0
  z: 0.0
angular:
  x: 0.0
  y: 0.0
  z: 0.0
---
```

6.2 Verify Robotic Arm Control Commands and Feedback

```
# Listen to single servo control commands published by the keyboard node
ros2 topic echo /arm_joint

# Listen to actual robotic arm joint status feedback from the driver node
ros2 topic echo /arm_status/arm_joint
```

After pressing `1` to switch to joint 1 and then pressing `a` to increase the angle, the `/arm_joint` topic will capture:

```
id: 1
joint: 95
time: 200
---
```

6.3 View Currently Active Nodes and Parameter Lists

```
# View all running nodes
ros2 node list

# View all adjustable parameters of the keyboard control node
ros2 param list /yahboom_keyboard_ctrl
```